CHAPTER 47

KOHLI AND COOK

1–4 August 2018

ENGLAND vs INDIA, 1st Test, *Edgbaston*, *Birmingham*

England 287 and 180; India 274 and 162

England won by 31 runs

India 1st innings: **V Kohli 149**

7–11 September 2018

ENGLAND vs INDIA, 5th Test, *The Oval*, *London*

England 332 and 423/8 dec.; India 292 and 345

England won by 118 runs

England 2nd innings: **A Cook 147**; India 2nd innings: **J Anderson 22.3–11–45–3**

Ever since he has been touted as the next Tendulkar, Virat Kohli has been someone on my radar. It is something that has become a pattern of my relationship with the external world – these rivalries and battles with other key players from India, Australia and beyond. As the leader of the England attack, my thoughts are always on the talismanic batter for the other team. Both of us set the tone and some of the character of our sides.

Kohli has come to England in 2018 with a reputation for being the best in the world – a generational talent at his peak. I had the better of him in the last series in England in 2014, and he's come back now with a desire to prove he can do it outside of his most natural conditions. I understand this aspiration to push yourself to the outer reaches of your ability, to be fuelled